

Chapter 105-4

Xu Qingzhu was very angry.

She was angry at herself for not solving the puzzles faster, for not finding Liang Shi sooner.

She was also angry at herself for agreeing to come play the escape room with her. Even more, she was angry at herself because she had known before playing that it was a five-star horror dungeon, yet she had still mischievously wanted to see Liang Shi embarrassed and scared, so she had gone to play this dungeon without Liang Shi knowing.

She was also angry that Liang Shi never learned to be good to herself, always putting others' needs and feelings first, forgetting that she herself was the one who needed love the most.

Since she was little, Liang Shi had always said she wanted to have lots and lots of love.

But even now, she only knew how to love others.

She was quiet, selfless, gentle, and tolerant—like warm mountain spring water, nourishing everything it flowed past.

Yet she alone forgot to love herself.

Xu Qingzhu was wearing a teal wool coat, dark blue jeans, and a pair of polished black knee-high boots with five-centimeter heels on her feet, making her look tall and slender.

But in the autumn wind, her fine, soft hair was blown about, and the hem of her coat was lifted too. Her whole person seemed desolate and lonely.

After heaving a heavy sigh, she turned and walked toward the mall entrance.

In Liang Shi's eyes, it was a feeling of being frustrated with someone who wouldn't live up to expectations—so she didn't want to say more.

Liang Shi's hand dropped to hang at her side, Xu Qingzhu's words echoing repeatedly in her mind.

—I'm not asking you to tell me anything, and I'm not asking you to do anything for me. Just be yourself properly.

"Just be yourself properly."

How difficult those five characters were.

All along, people had only ever told her: you need to work hard and move forward, you need to establish some kind of persona, you need to become an actress that others love, you need to play roles that audiences like, you need to show your best side.

Almost everyone demanded that she be perfect, demanded that she be someone others liked.

Yet this was the first time someone had said—just be yourself properly.

What would probably follow was—I'll love you.

Liang Shi's heart was filled with something unknown, softening into a complete mess.

After Xu Qingzhu had walked a few steps, when that sentence had echoed in her mind for the third time, Liang Shi suddenly curved her lips into a smile.

She lifted her feet and jogged over, catching up to Xu Qingzhu in just a few steps.

Her hand grabbed Xu Qingzhu's forearm. Xu Qingzhu turned her head, her eyes still red.

Liang Shi opened her arms and hugged her tightly.

On the busy street with people coming and going, the streetlights cast a dim, golden glow.

Liang Shi buried her head in Xu Qingzhu's neck, her voice low and hoarse: "Xu Qingzhu."

Xu Qingzhu's hands curled a few times in her pockets. In the end, she still didn't reach out, only humming a note: "Mm?"

"Don't be angry," Liang Shi said. "I was really upset just now."

Xu Qingzhu's chin rested on her shoulder. She could feel her hair and could smell the fresh orange scent in this world full of earthly warmth—it was the same shampoo she used.

Liang Shi said: "If you asked me to coax you right now, I would be unhappy and would think you were being unreasonable."

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but reach out and pinch her waist, letting out a soft hum: "I am pretty unreasonable to begin with."

"How could that be?" Liang Shi laughed softly. It was the first genuine laugh since leaving that shop—she laughed so hard her body trembled, and Xu Qingzhu trembled along with her. "Our Teacher Xu is the most understanding person in the world."

"Oh, stop." Xu Qingzhu pushed her, but Liang Shi held onto her and said: "I'm very upset today, so is it okay if I don't coax you?"

Liang Shi said: "If you're really angry, can I coax you tomorrow instead?"

Xu Qingzhu's hand that had been pinching her waist paused, then settled at her waist. "Then I'll coax you."